Stakeholder Map

IIIT Hyderabad Breakfast Mess System

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Use Case

The breakfast system at IIIT Hyderabad registers, bills and serves breakfast to resident students in four messes (Kadamba, Palash, Bakul and Yuktāhār) through one digital platform. Registration counts, not attendance, drive billing and the quantity each operator cooks. Three caterers run the four messes. Two cook on site, and Bakul's, Vijayalakshmi Caterers, cooks at the Hafizpet kitchen and trucks the food in. This map identifies every actor, institution and informal structure that takes part in the system, shapes it, benefits from it or is affected by it, and the relationships, dependencies and conflicts between them.

Operator visits, the Yuktāhār registers, Kadamba's scan-level April records and a later account of the Bakul manager overturned several first-version findings about the vendors, the four-day lead time and who places food orders. Each change is marked as revised where it appears. There are no Bakul records, so every Bakul figure here is the manager's own statement or estimate.

Stakeholders

Primary, Secondary, and Indirect Stakeholders

Thirty-two candidate actors were identified through seventeen lenses (student, social, food production, governance, money, technology, academic, sleep and time use, substitutes, campus infrastructure, waste, health, policy, informal systems, absent or sleeping actors, temporal, intervention). Seven became visible only once the operators' own practice was observed: operator site management, the CDS site team, suppliers, the garbage contractor, event and exam organisers, quality-check visitors and the food-safety regulator. One more, the Student Parliament's mess seats, came from the Parliament's published records. Twenty-four are in the final map.

Five were treated as minor. Cleaning staff and the juice canteens add no leverage beyond serving staff and Vindhya. Guest diners are counted by the operators themselves and stay too small for a full stakeholder: Yuktāhār's register shows none to twelve unregistered, paying or faculty and staff diners per breakfast on the legible September days (confirmed, records). Quality-check visitors, described by Kadamba's manager as IIIT faculty who inspect the store

and by the operator as a weekly QC inspection, are read as a role of the Mess Committee's faculty, which is a candidate identity. The food-safety regulator certifies the campus but has no part in attendance. Three were excluded: a campus health office (its only link to the messes is food safety), senior-to-junior norm transmission, and a parental financial relationship (mess fees are bundled into hostel fees).

Revised: Kadamba's extra portions were first described as 30 to 40 for paying walk-ins, with security staff sharing a leftover meal. The operator's own account is that about 30 extra portions are cooked in advance for 30 to 50 people outside the student registration, such as night-shift security, and that about half of Kadamba's staff also eat from the same food (single-sourced). Together they are a large, uncounted sink for first-batch surplus (candidate), so they now count as a stakeholder: non-student diners fed at Kadamba.

Primary stakeholders: direct, daily interaction with the system.

Stakeholder	Type
Students	Human group: registrant, billed party, consumer
Operator: Prism, Kadamba (hired by tender; South Indian, veg and non-veg, on-site kitchen)	Commercial
Operator: Vijayalakshmi Caterers, Bakul (North Indian; cooks at Hafizpet; Palash served from the same off-site kitchen, candidate)	Commercial
Operator: ABC Hospitality Services, Yuktāhār (Satvik vegetarian and Jain, on-site kitchen)	Commercial
Operator site management (Kadamba: operations manager, manager, supervisor; Yuktāhār: project managers, in-charge, coordinator, store function; Bakul: the manager who phones Hafizpet)	Human group: decides tomorrow's quantities and today's top-ups
Mess serving and counter staff	Human group
Kitchen and cooking staff	Human group

Secondary stakeholders: govern, execute or manage the system without daily direct interaction.

Stakeholder	Type
Mess Committee	Institution: policy
Mess Office (candidate: CDS, Campus Dining Services)	Institution: operations, registration rules
CDS site team	Institution: day-to-day liaison with operators
Warden	Individual role: vendor management, structural change
Student Parliament Mess Secretary, and a Mess Deputy Secretary per mess (Kadamba, Palash, Yuktāhār)	Elected roles: student representation

The institution's posters and the operators name a Campus Dining Services (CDS) body under Campus Facilities Services (CFS), with a faculty CDS Committee, a CDS Student Council and one admin per mess. Kadamba's operator describes its contract chain as CFS, then CDS, then Prism (single-sourced). Five identities are unconfirmed and kept apart here: whether CDS is the Mess Office, whether the CDS Committee is the Mess Committee, whether the CDS Student Council is the Parliament's mess seat or part of it, whether the Warden's vendor and structural role belongs to CFS, and who leads CDS. The Kadamba operator names one person as head of CDS and the CFS Chair earlier named another as CDS Chair, which may be two roles or one wrong name. The first identity is now the stronger candidate, because the CDS team supplied the scan-level records and its site team is the operators' day-to-day counterpart.

Indirect stakeholders: affected by or connected to the system without direct engagement, including sleeping actors that are inert now but hold potential leverage.

Stakeholder	Type
Academic administration and timetable authority	Institution: latent
Event and exam organisers (clubs, hackathons, other campus food events)	Institutional and informal: latent demand shifters
Facilities and Estate team	Institution: latent
Portal and IT system owner	Institution or individual: latent
Suppliers (local shops and godowns, vegetable vendors, milk, paneer, oil and flour mills, LPG)	Commercial: upstream supply

Stakeholder	Type
Garbage contractor	Commercial: waste exit
Non-student diners fed at Kadamba (night-shift security and other outside workers; about half of Kadamba's staff)	Human group: surplus absorber
Mess Cell WhatsApp community	Informal group
Unofficial mess-tool developers	Individuals: latent
Ping (student publication)	Institution: latent
Vindhya Canteen and the juice canteens	Commercial: substitute
Delivery platforms and riders	Commercial: substitute

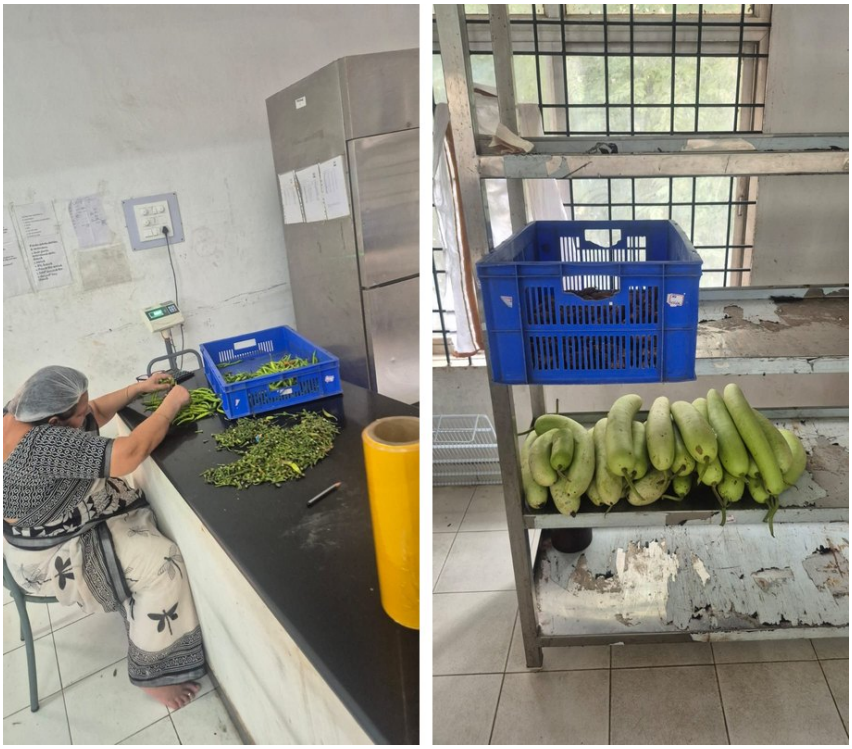


Figure 1. Staff at Yuktāhār's weighing station and the vegetable store, the people behind the books.

Stakeholder Interests, Needs, and Expectations

Stakeholder	Interest	Need	Expectation
Students	Convenient, affordable, timely food; not paying twice for a missed meal; keeping menu items they like	A working registration and billing system, predictable hours, food matching their diet, and entry when they arrive in the last minutes before close	Registering reliably means being fed if they attend; being charged regardless is a tolerated rule, not an agreed one. Registration is automatic and mandatory, even on holidays or off campus, and the only exit is five cancellations per meal type per month, at least four days ahead (confirmed). It is a default, not a daily decision: April breakfast registrations sat near 1,070 every day while turnout ran from 42.1% on Tuesdays to 27.3% on Sundays (confirmed, records). A Kadamba student objected in person that dinner sambar was dropped ”while they are taking more money from us”

Stakeholder	Interest	Need	Expectation
Operator: Prism (Kadamba)	Renewal and margin under a tendered per-plate rate; whether payment is per registered or served plate is unconfirmed	Registration counts split veg and non-veg, released about four days ahead; dry goods a week ahead, most perishables the day before; a raw reserve cookable in 10 to 15 minutes; live counter counts	Revised: the expectation that the four-day count approximates demand fails for every operator. Kadamba cooks about 70% of registrations first against 37.1% turnout (confirmed, records) and treats the count as an obligation it is paid for. Its manager says there is no forecasting method (”it was wasted many times”). It puts waste at 5 to 10% a day on an unstated base, which fits a 70% batch against 37% turnout only if extra diners, reheating or small top-ups absorb the rest (single-sourced)
Operator: Vijayalakshmi Caterers (Bakul; Palash candidate)	Renewal and margin, paid monthly as a lump sum with deductions; says payment is on plates served (single-sourced, flagged under Dependencies). Its manager's principle is ”there should not be a shortage of food, even if some wastage occurs”, and he wants a say in the menu, above all in pairings	Registration counts; its own supply (paneer moved from Amul to Heritage to Milky Mist after quality complaints); a phone line to Hafizpet and a 20 to 40 minute transport leg for every top-up, with total lead time unstated	Revised: the reading that Bakul cooks a fixed 70%, lately raised to 80%, is withdrawn. The first batch is about 70 to 80% by item, set from weekly review of attendance history, and about 70% even on very low weekends. The manager checks stock about every 30 minutes and estimates at most about 60% of registered students come; no records exist to test it. He is a month into the post with about 20 years in North Indian food (single-sourced)
Operator: ABC Hospitality Services (Yuktāhār)	Renewal and margin, with an explicit goal of best quality, less waste, an optimised workflow, lower cost and higher profit, in which waste cutting is a cost lever; keeping prediction in its own hands (”I want to remain close to the data”)	Registrations read as regular plus Jain plus cash meals; its Wastage Book for the matching week; the weekday attendance register; the month's pattern; and news of holidays and events, which arrives only if someone raises it in the planning meeting. The first half hour of service is a sample to project the rest (single-sourced)	Plans from its own records yet believes breakfast turnout is at most about 50%; its September register shows 17.7 to 40.2%, about 28% across the thirteen legible days (confirmed, records)
Operator site management	Getting tomorrow's quantities right; staff buy-in to waste tracking	Yuktāhār: a twice-daily meeting with the books on the table. Kadamba: the supervisor's reading of the counters. Bakul: the manager's weekly review, 30-minute checks and a reserve for about 50 people at 9:20. Whether Bakul's review is written down is unknown	Waste measurement is for improvement, not fault-finding. Yuktāhār's cross-checkers are paid less than the person checked, weighing was made blame-free and discussed daily, and staff who first said ”they are catching us” reported waste falling by December (single-sourced)
Serving and kitchen staff	A manageable load and predictable headcounts	Live counts, a second counter during the closing surge (Yuktāhār opens two roti counters at peak, confirmed by observation), reserve raw material, and a working QR scanner (on failure, ID and name are written by hand). Kadamba's chef starts at 5:30 and dosa is cooked live from 7:00. At Hafizpet, labour-heavy items such as aloo paratha may start about 3 AM for a 7 AM arrival, and steam in the boxes softens them (single-sourced)	Revised: the figure of 20 to 30 cooking and security staff eating what students leave is replaced by about half of Kadamba's staff eating from the same food. Whether that is an entitlement or a norm is unconfirmed (single-sourced)
Non-student diners fed at Kadamba	A meal on shift without leaving campus	Cooked food available alongside student service, planned through the extra portions	Food is simply there. They absorb first-batch surplus that no waste or attendance record counts (candidate)

Stakeholder	Interest	Need	Expectation
Mess Committee	Balancing student satisfaction against feasibility; menu authority, exercised by choosing from operator-offered options	A working way to gather and read student input	The menu-input process is enough for mess matters generally, including hours and billing it was never built for. No source confirms that operators' item-level waste figures reach it
Mess Office (candidate: CDS)	Lower operational workload, the stated motive behind its one policy change on record (candidate, from a secondhand press summary); ownership of the four-day registration rule	Revised: the earlier ”need” for a same-day picture of intent does not hold, since the CDS team already holds a scan for every registration (11,941 of 32,162 Kadamba breakfasts availed in April). It lacks a route from those records into the rules	Counts are a workable proxy for attendance. Its own records contradict this, and no operator acts on it
CDS site team	Keeping operations and complaints moving	A direct line to each operator: a WhatsApp group relaying complaints and instructions (single-sourced)	Not established
Warden	Stable vendor relationships, orderly infrastructure	A clear split of responsibility from the Mess Office	Vendor and structural authority stay in the Warden's own lane
Student Parliament Mess Secretary and per-mess Deputy Secretaries	Representing students on mess matters	A working channel into the Mess Committee and Mess Office	Not established. Whether the seat carries a vote in the institute-level Committee or only in a Parliament-internal one is unconfirmed
Academic administration	Class scheduling, run without outside interference	No stated need connects it to the mess	No expectation of any relationship to mess governance; confirmed to hold no formal mess role
Event and exam organisers	Running their own events	None connects them to the messes	Not established. Exams and hackathons cut turnout and a food event elsewhere means a kitchen should cook less, but nothing formal tells the kitchen (single-sourced, Yuktāhār operator)
Facilities and Estate team	Infrastructure upkeep	Budget and approval for mess-facility work (the Kadamba renovation occurred; its toaster and grill are broken with no replacement, single-sourced)	Not established; the actor's identity is itself unconfirmed
Portal and IT owner	Uptime and reliability of registration	Working scanners; the system already gives operators their counts, the counter live scans and CDS a timestamp per scan	Not established; no source names this actor
Suppliers	Steady orders and repeat business	Orders at each operator's cadence. Yuktāhār buys groceries fortnightly from many local shops and godowns (confirmed, stock register), vegetables two or three times a week and milk daily; Kadamba buys dry goods a week ahead, most perishables the day before and some vegetables two or three days ahead (single-sourced)	Operators check and return poor stock. Yuktāhār holds an expected grams-of-waste norm per raw item (50 g of stones in 2 kg of grain was weighed), complains to or changes the supplier when it is exceeded, visits the mills that make its oil, and has used rock salt and cold-pressed oil for about six months. Vijayalakshmi Caterers changed paneer brand twice (single-sourced)
Garbage contractor	A collection business	Daily access to each operator's bins	Not established. At Kadamba all uneaten cooked surplus goes to the bin and then to this contractor, with no composting (single-sourced)
Mess Cell community	Recovering value from a registration that will go unused	A way to transfer a registration, since Skip Meal returns no money	Buyers and sellers find each other and trade on trust. Kadamba's manager holds a related belief that students register while away and a friend eats in their place (single-sourced; his belief, not an observation)

Stakeholder	Interest	Need	Expectation
Unofficial mess-tool developers	Not established beyond building the tool	Not established	The tool's own documentation says it is built ”for students of IIIT Hyderabad”
Ping	Reporting on mess issues as student interest	Material worth publishing	Not established whether coverage produces any institutional response
Vindhya Canteen and juice canteens	Capturing demand when mess breakfast is skipped	Steady walk-in flow	Not established
Delivery platforms and riders	Capturing the same demand	Gate access, currently restricted	Not established

Formal and Informal Roles

Every institutional and commercial actor holds a formal, rule-defined or contract-defined position: students as registrants, the Mess Committee, the Mess Office, the CDS site team, the Warden, the three operators, serving and kitchen staff, suppliers, the garbage contractor, the canteens and the delivery platforms.

Formal roles inside the operators. Each operator runs its own organisation, which the institution does not see. The two on-site ones are opposites, and Bakul splits across two sites.

Kadamba sits at the end of a contract chain from CFS to CDS to Prism, and inside Prism from an operations manager to a manager, a supervisor and the service staff (single-sourced). A separate staff recording adds a director above the operations manager; reading that as Prism's ladder is a candidate. The supervisor is the in-service quantity decider: they watch the counters, track how much of each item is left at what time and tell the kitchen how much more to cook. The kitchen has about ten chefs with separate veg and non-veg cooks, a main vegetarian chef, and a head chef who joins on biryani days. Up to fifty staff work at the mess (single-sourced). Every meal passes a fixed safety sequence before service: cooking temperature checked, a sample kept 72 hours, a wrapped display plate set at the entrance (confirmed, observed), serving temperature per item, then a tasting by a facility team with two Prism staff (confirmed, observed) and corrections. Water TDS is read daily and QC inspects weekly. Who the facility team is (CDS site team, CFS, Facilities and Estate, or faculty visitors) is not confirmed and is kept separate from each.

Yuktāhār has no hierarchy: everyone does every job and peers cross-check. ABC runs the mess through two project managers, with about three site staff sharing the work (single-sourced; revised from a five-person team). The mess in-charge keeps the accounts and the Wastage Register, and colleagues check those records. A cross-verifier writes and checks the grocery register, and their signature is on the photographed fridge cleaning log (confirmed). A co-ordinator keeps the registrations, the weekday attendance register and a wastage board with a falling waste-share target. The store function pulls, sorts and cleans raw material but is nobody's dedicated job. A tasting pair checks every breakfast, with cutting and cleaning teams alongside, and sixteen kitchen staff start cooking at 5:30 to be ready by 7:30. A site head has run the mess since the takeover and writes in the registers daily; whether they are one of the two project managers is unconfirmed. Each role attaches to a book (Wastage Book, weekday attendance register and board, grocery issue book, store ingredient book, stock register, vegetable book and indent, milk, fruit, gas, electricity and water register, fridge logs), all photographed (confirmed), and each book is checked by someone other than its keeper. What was issued must match what was cooked, and a mismatch goes to the daily meeting; on 18 September the grocery book and stock register agreed on toor dal (confirmed). An office digitises the paper books later.

Bakul (Vijayalakshmi Caterers) splits two sites: Hafizpet cooks, and the mess holds, serves and decides. The operator describes a line from staff to the manager to a managing director, and a complaint route from the CDS team to the manager, the kitchen and the managing director (single-sourced). The manager is the single quantity decider at the mess. This puts Bakul between the other two, with a weekly judgement rather than Kadamba's fixed share or Yuktāhār's books and no book of its own that any source has seen (candidate).

Informal roles belong to the Mess Cell community, Ping and the tool developers. None has official standing and each does a real job: a resale market, a public-pressure channel and an alternative registration interface. The operators add informal structures of their own. Yuktāhār's twice-daily meeting is the system's real forecasting institution, and no institutional document names it. It also carries Yuktāhār's informal organisation. There is no leave policy, so absences are raised there and colleagues agree to cover. One project manager took all staff to his farmhouse for training on what good quality looks like, and staff describe a family-like culture (single-sourced). That informal layer

holds the formal books together. The WhatsApp group between the CDS site team and each operator carries formal business informally. At Kadamba, meals for outside diners and half the staff, the door reopened for 5 to 10 minutes after close (25 students came after close on one biryani day) and the back door that, in the operator's words, the mess ”can't say no” to, are accommodations that absorb surplus and lateness with no rule requiring them (single-sourced).

Roles that are not separate stakeholders. Attending regularly, skipping regularly, having an early class, selling on Mess Cell and using an unofficial tool are states one student moves through in a week. Peer influence is a relationship inside the Students node, not a separate ”Friends” stakeholder. Guest diners have a different formal relationship (no registration, a higher spot rate) but too little volume for their own node. Students also act as menu selectors. In the Bakul manager's account, students choose combinations from balanced diet, protein, carbohydrate and preference, while he reasons from traditional pairings, regional habit and what is eaten (single-sourced; residents have not been asked). Whether residents differ in regional familiarity, diet and breakfast habit in ways that matter for menus is untested, so menu research at Bakul should sample along those lines (research implication, candidate).

Create the Map

Stakeholder Map

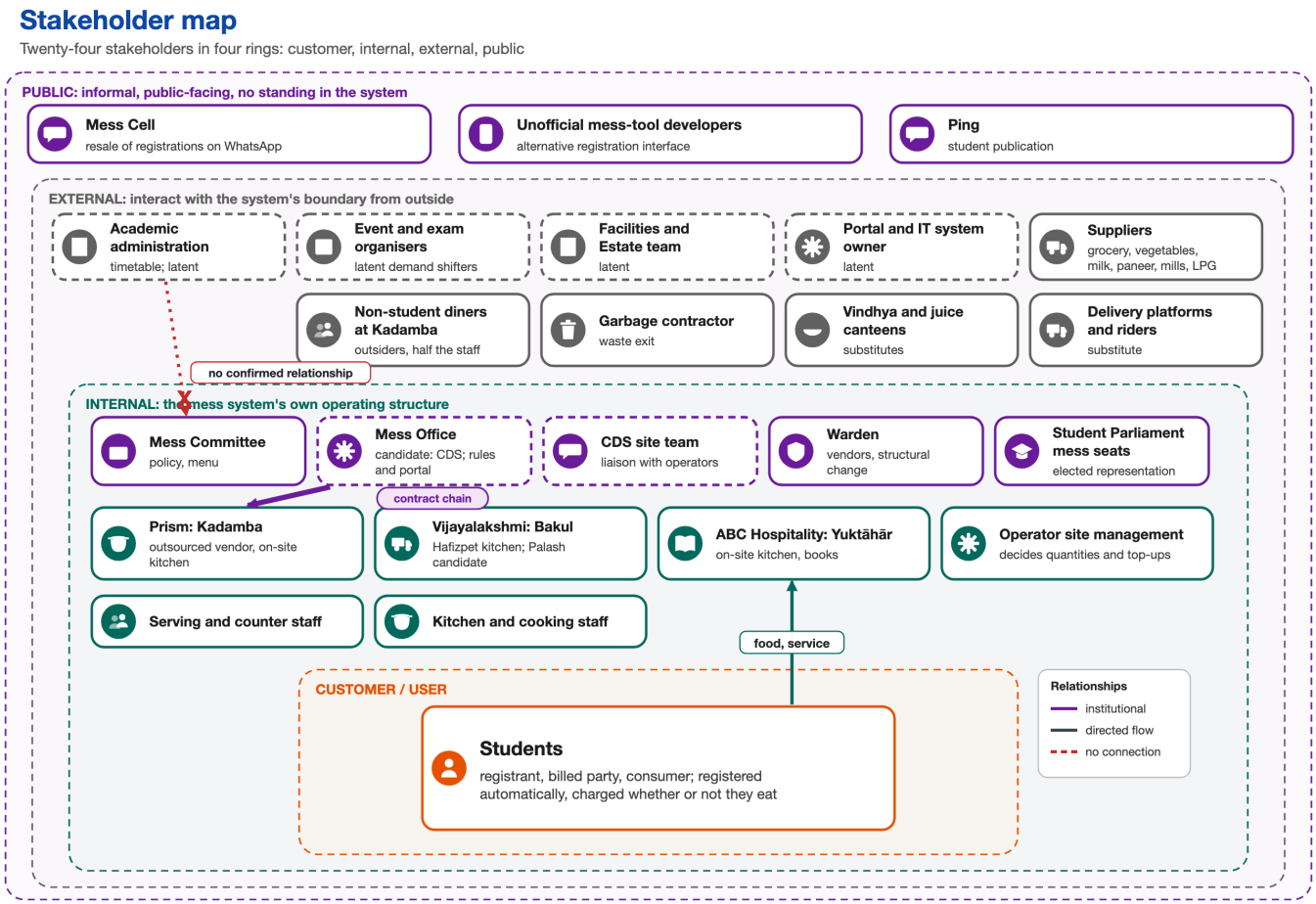


Figure 2. Stakeholder map in four rings: customer, internal, external and public.

Legend: relationship types

Style	Relationship
Solid line, plain label	Relation
Dotted line	Unclear, informal relationship

Style	Relationship
Thick line	Institutional relationship
Solid arrow, labeled	Directed flow of information
Red line	Relationship with conflict potential
Dotted line ending in an X	Interrupted relationship (no confirmed connection)

Placement follows the four-ring model. The customer or user is Students. Internal stakeholders are the Mess Committee, Mess Office, CDS site team, Warden, the Parliament's mess seats, the three operators with their site management, and serving and kitchen staff. External stakeholders are Academic administration, event and exam organisers, Facilities and Estate, the Portal and IT owner, suppliers, the garbage contractor, the non-student diners (placed next to the operators), the canteens and delivery platforms. Public stakeholders are Mess Cell, the tool developers and Ping: informal, public-facing actors with no standing in the system.

Relationship Network

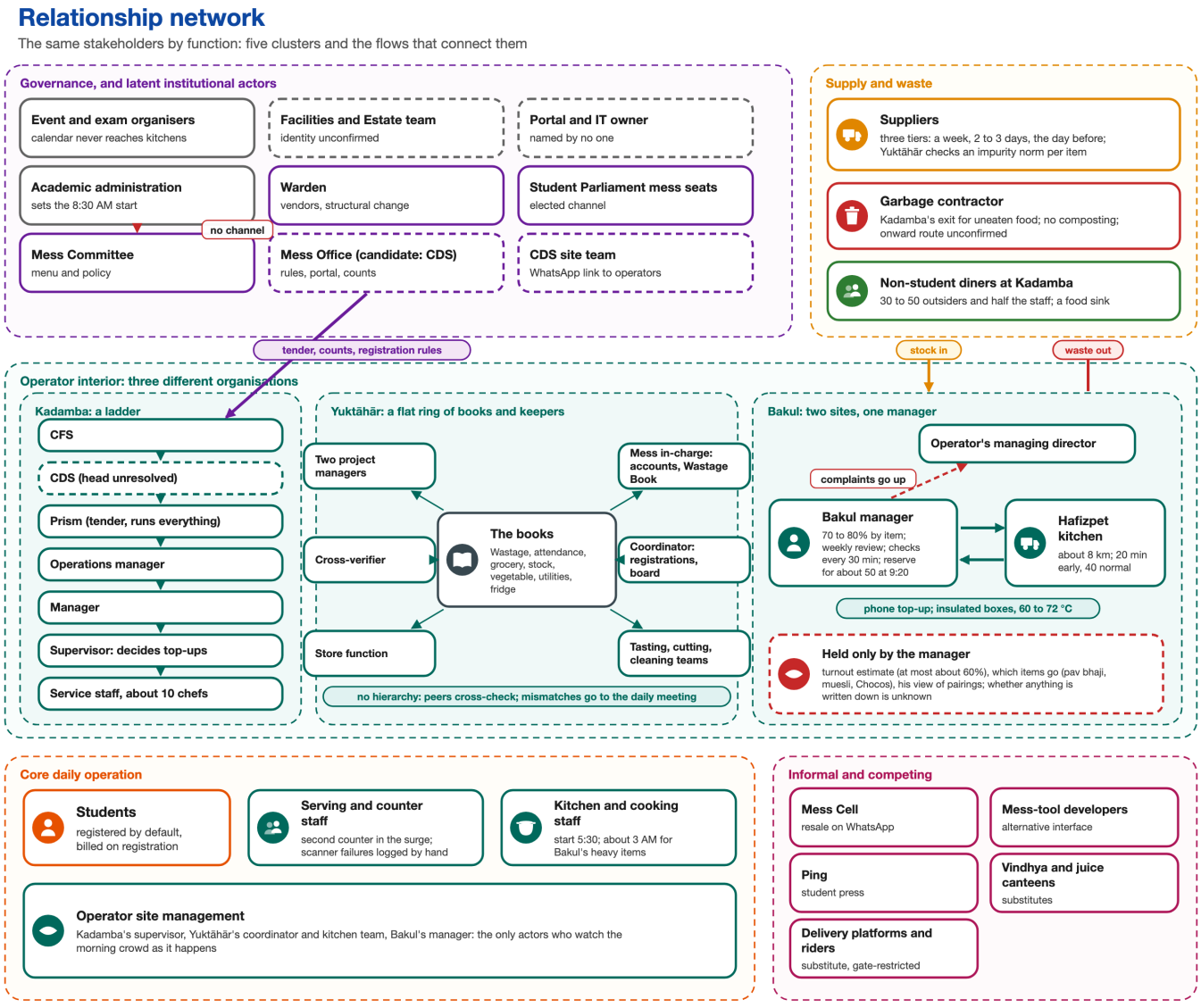


Figure 3. *Relationship network: five clusters, with the flows of authority, money, food, information and complaints.*

The same twenty-four stakeholders fall into five clusters: core daily operation, operator interior, governance, supply and waste, and informal or competing actors. The operator interior holds two opposite organisations, Kadamba's ladder from CFS through CDS to Prism and the supervisor, and Yuktāhār's flat, peer-checked ring of books and keepers. Bakul adds a third arrangement: one manager at the mess, linked by phone and road to a kitchen 8 km away. The manager takes registration counts from the portal and sets the first batch from a weekly review of attendance history, 70 to 80% by item and about 70% on low weekends. He checks stock about every 30 minutes, phones Hafizpet for top-ups on a lead time nobody has stated, and holds a reserve for about 50 at 9:20. Complaints run from the CDS team to the manager, the kitchen and the operator's managing director. Money arrives as a monthly lump sum on plates ”served”, with deductions (basis flagged). The manager's turnout estimate, his view of which items go and his view of good pairings are held only by him, routed nowhere known (single-sourced; no Bakul records exist).

Proximity to the Student's Lived Experience

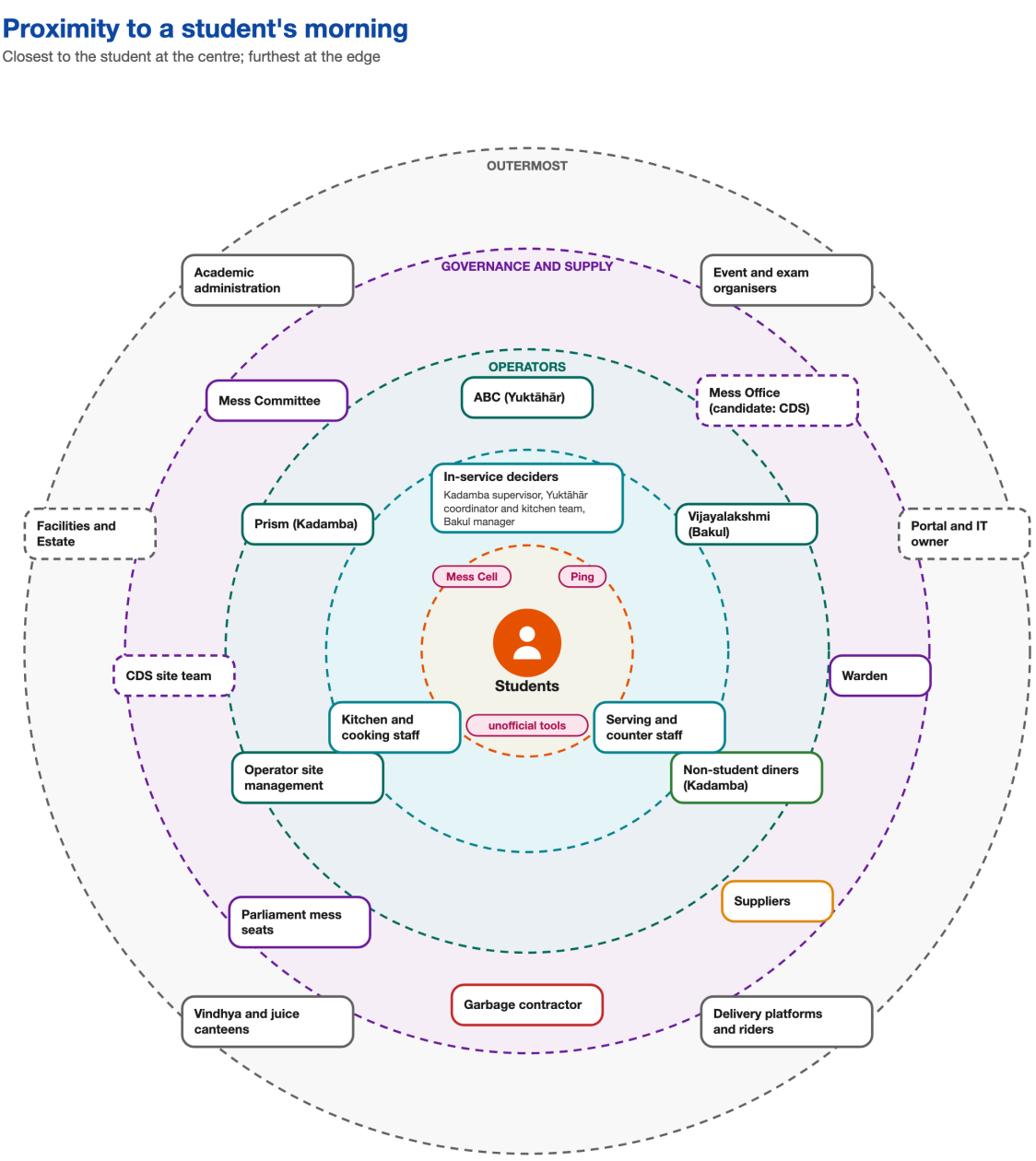


Figure 4. Proximity map: how close each stakeholder is to a student's actual morning.

Clustering by closeness to a student's actual morning gives a different picture from the two maps above. Academic administration and the event and exam organisers sit in the outermost ring with no adjacent relationship at any layer, while Mess Cell, the unofficial tools and Ping, none of them part of formal governance, sit in the innermost ring beside the students. The counter staff and the in-service deciders (Kadamba's supervisor, Yuktāhār's coordinator and kitchen team, Bakul's manager) also sit close. They are the only actors who see the morning crowd as it happens.

Relationships, Dependencies, and Conflicts

Relationship Matrix

Cells marked *hypothesis* are not independently confirmed. Blank cells mean no source describes a relationship.

	Students	Mess Cttee	Mess Office (CDS)	Warden	Academi admin.	Operators	Staff	Mess Cell	Ping
Students	n/a	Rating system exists; whether read is un-confirmed	Register and pay; automatic, 5 cancels per meal type per month		Bound to its timetable	Counter service, complaints, late entry	Service	Pay, serve	
Mess Committee	Authority (menu, feedback)	n/a	Sets policy	Hypothes overlap	None	Menu from operator-offered options; faculty store visits (candidate)			Hypothesis: subject of cov-erage
Mess Office (CDS)	Billing, rules (four-day exit)	Hypothesis: reports to	n/a	Hypothes overlap	None	Contract chain CFS, CDS, Prism; counts at four days; WhatsApp complaint relay; monthly pay with deductions; facility tasting; scan records not shared back	Indirect		Hypothesis: subject of cov-erage
Warden		Hypothesis	Hypothesis	n/a	None	Contract authority			
Operators	Food, plate-waste weighing, late entry	Menu options; item-level waste data with no route to the Com-mittee	Depend on it for counts and pay	Under con-tract	Event news only by chance	Compete for the same diner	Kadamba: Prism ladder. Yuktāhār: flat, peer checks. Bakul: staff, manager, MD, phone to Hafizpet		
Staff	Service; half of Kadamba's staff eat the same food					Report to (Kadamba); cross-check and taste in pairs (Yuktāhār)	n/a		
Non-student diners (Kadamba)	Eat the same food					Cooked for in advance, about 30 extra portions; outside registration unconfirmed	Share the food		
Suppliers						Supply, impurity norm, returns, brand switching, mill visits			
Garbage contractor						Daily bin collection (Kadamba); onward route unconfirmed			
Mess Cell	Pay, serve, informal influence							n/a	

The empty cells matter as much as the full ones. Academic administration has no confirmed relationship of any kind to any of the three governance actors. That is a structural gap, not a modelling omission, and the most consequential finding in this map. The operator side shows the same gap from below, since the academic and event calendar reaches a kitchen only if someone mentions it in a meeting. The Mess Office row shows a second gap: the institution and the operators each measure turnout, and nothing connects the two measurements.

Dependencies

Students depend on operators for food quality and timing. Operators depend on no individual student, an asymmetry consistent with a walk-in price that needs no negotiation. Operators depend on the Mess Office for counts released four days ahead and on the contract for payment. Revised: operators do not depend on that count to procure food. Procurement is theirs and runs on its own cadence (Yuktāhār groceries fortnightly, vegetables two or three times a week, milk daily, confirmed from its registers; Kadamba dry goods a week ahead, most perishables the day before). What the count sets is how much cooked food is prepared, since every operator converts registrations into a cooked quantity and cooked food lasts only three to four hours. Kadamba uses a fixed first-batch share. Bakul uses 70 to 80% by item, adjusted weekly and not below about 70%. Yuktāhār uses its records, its meeting and a first-half-hour projection. The Mess Office depends on students to register accurately, but nothing in billing rewards accuracy: a student pays the same whether or not they attend and is registered automatically unless one of the capped cancellations is used. The weakest link in the chain has no incentive attached. The Mess Committee depends on the Mess Office to execute policy. The Office's one confirmed policy change, motivated by workload (candidate), did not visibly come from the Committee, which suggests operational pressure may drive policy from below as often as governance drives it from above.

Operators depend on suppliers for clean raw stock, on the garbage contractor to remove what is not eaten and, at Bakul, on the road. Revised: that leg was first given as 40 minutes from a kitchen near the airport, with top-ups arriving within 30 minutes. The kitchen is about 8 km away, a drive of about 20 minutes early in the morning and 40 in normal traffic, and a top-up needs a phone call, cooking and that drive. Total lead time is unstated, so the 30-minute figure survives only as a noisy-audio reading that transit alone makes doubtful (single-sourced). A top-up called late in the window would miss the close, which is a candidate reason the manager holds food for about 50 at 9:20, several times the 10 to 15 he says arrive in the last ten minutes. The same boxes keep food hot and soften it, so Bakul's quality depends on the transport link as well as the kitchen (aloo paratha only; other items untested). Kitchen staff depend on the QR scanner and portal for live counts. Operators also depend on one another without planning to: Yuktāhār's site head blames weak Wednesday paneer turnout on another mess serving something more attractive that day, so the messes substitute for each other as well as for Vindhya, the juice canteens and delivery.

A dependency runs the other way at Kadamba. The outside diners and about half the staff eat what the fixed first batch produces (single-sourced), so any cut to that batch takes food from people nobody has consulted unless their portions are planned explicitly. They are a latent opponent of waste reduction (candidate).

Revised: the first version said vendors and students have no direct relationship and everything routes through the Mess Office or portal. They meet daily at the counter. A student complained in person to Kadamba's manager about the dropped sambar and got a direct answer, operators absorb latecomers through a door and a back door they say they cannot refuse, and Yuktāhār weighs student plate waste. Only formal complaints route through institutional channels, running from a director's email or the CDS team to the manager and the kitchen, and at Bakul on to the managing director (single-sourced). No source describes the Portal and IT owner having any direct relationship with the Mess Committee, although the Committee sets policy that the system presumably enforces.

One contract dependency matters more than any other cell. Vijayalakshmi Caterers says it won a tender and is paid monthly on plates with deductions, with tender figures unclear on the recording, and that payment is on plates served (single-sourced). If plates mean registrations, an operator cooking for well under all of them keeps a margin on every no-show and has no financial interest in closing the gap. If plates mean meals served, the reverse holds. Bakul's ”served” and Kadamba's ”we cook on registrations because they are getting paid for it” pull opposite ways. The contracts may differ, ”served” may be a normalised word for billed plates, or Kadamba's remark may describe a duty rather than a formula. One word in one account does not settle Bakul, still less the others, so the question stays open for every operator until the contract wording or CDS confirms it. If Bakul is paid on plates served, it bears the cost of over-cooking and accepts it to avoid a shortage (candidate).

Influence

Influence splits by what each actor controls. Operators hold high local influence over how much is cooked, when a batch is topped up and whether a second counter opens, and they respond within 10 to 30 minutes. At Kadamba that minute-to-minute decision sits with the supervisor, at Yuktāhār with the kitchen team reading the first half hour. At Bakul the manager decides, but every top-up adds a 20 to 40 minute drive to the cooking time. Latecomers are absorbed, not decided on, since students at the back door cannot be refused. Operators hold no influence over the registration cut-off, the billing rule or the service window, and their influence over the menu is contested. Bakul's manager is the clearest case: he holds pairing knowledge and sees what is eaten, yet in his account students choose the combinations, and which menu decisions he can override is unknown (single-sourced). The Mess Office holds the registration and billing rules and the only scan-level attendance data, and has no confirmed influence over how much any operator cooks. The Mess Committee holds menu authority and the final say on policy. Academic administration holds the class timetable, the variable most in conflict with breakfast hours, and exerts no influence on the mess at all. Students supply the input everyone else plans around and have no influence over any rule, except informally through Mess Cell and direct complaint at the counter.

Conflicts

Conflict	Side A	Side B
Billing certainty vs. attendance uncertainty	The Mess Office locks registration four days ahead and bills on it; operators turn the count into cooked food at a share each sets: fixed at Kadamba, weekly at Bakul, from books at Yuktāhār	Students' attendance is uncertain day to day and nothing in billing rewards reporting it. Revised: vendors do not need the four-day number to buy food, since perishables are ordered one day ahead and groceries in bulk
Flexibility vs. workload	Students and the Mess Cell market want easier cancellation and resale; they face automatic registration, five cancellations per meal type per month at least four days ahead, and no way off the charge beyond that (confirmed)	The Mess Office's one confirmed policy change tightened rules to reduce staff workload (candidate)
Convenience vs. waste	Students want flexible registration	The Mess Office wants predictable, low-workload ordering
Operator stance on registrations	Kadamba treats the count as an obligation and cooks against it whoever is expected to eat	Yuktāhār treats waste as a cost it can cut and ties reduction to profit. Bakul's manager holds a third stance: shortage is the failure to avoid and waste is its price. A run-out is visible and draws complaints up to the managing director while a surplus is silent, so the stance may be the kitchen's answer to which failure gets noticed (candidate). All three work under one registration-based system, so the difference is operator culture (candidate; single-sourced)
Waste reduction vs. who eats the surplus	Any cut to Kadamba's first batch reduces surplus that becomes waste	30 to 50 outside diners and about half the staff eat from that food and would lose it unless planned for (candidate)
Over-preparation vs. food quality at Kadamba	The fixed first batch and live top-ups keep the counters full	By the team's own judgement, food is cooked ahead, reheated and moved between vessels, and degrades fast; students complain about quality. The link from held food to complaints is a candidate, not evidenced

Conflict	Side A	Side B
Menu ownership vs. waste visibility	Students, the Committee and the Parliament own menu choice and feel the loss of liked items, as with the dropped dinner sambar	Operators see which items go to waste (uttapam, set dosa, upma at Kadamba; puri, bonda, vada and idli move) but hold no menu seat, and Yuktāhār's head says turnout data is not used for the menu. Kadamba's manager said both that students choose the menu and that the operator does, so authority there is unresolved. Bakul's manager says some pairings are wrong rather than the dishes (kachori belongs with chole, Raj Kachori with aloo curry), that students plan for nutrition where he plans for familiarity, that pav bhaji draws diners and muesli and Chocos go readily, and that a protein target of 30 to 40 g a meal exists, set by someone unknown. He blames low turnout partly on taste and partly on students not waking. Not waking matches what interviewed students say most; taste is not a leading reason in those interviews, none with a known Bakul resident (single-sourced; untested)
Late arrival vs. service close	26.5% of Kadamba's April breakfast scans fall between 9:15 and 9:30, building to about nine a minute by 9:29 (confirmed, records). The operator's rule of thumb matches: about 100 early, 100 in the middle, 150 in the last ten minutes	Operators reopen the door and top up with food near the end of its safe life, and students use the back door after 9:30; the same surge drives cooking ”just in case”. The surge differs by hall: Bakul's manager puts his main rush at 8:00 to 8:30 with 10 to 15 in the last ten minutes, and still keeps food for about 50 at 9:20 (single-sourced; no Bakul scans seen)
Fixed cuisine allocation vs. uneven turnout	Turnout differs by line and item even inside one mess: Kadamba's April breakfast turnout was 48.5% for non-veg and 32.4% for veg	Each hall's cuisine and kitchen are fixed by designation and contract and do not adjust to demand. Revised: procurement itself is not fixed
Temperature vs. texture in off-site transport (Bakul)	Early dispatch, insulated boxes at about 60 to 72 °C and hot-water holding keep food hot through the drive and service	Hot parathas steam and soften, so food arrives hot but less pleasant. The food held longest, including the late reserve, may suffer most; other items are untested (single-sourced; candidate)
Operator vs. supplier on quality	Operators need clean, consistent stock	Suppliers deliver grain with stones and paneer that draws complaints, which operators answer with an impurity norm, returns and brand or supplier switches
Low-bid tender vs. quality	The institution picks the lowest or closest bid against a published base rate (single-sourced)	Operators must hold quality and portions within that rate; margin pressure is a candidate tension
Staff vs. management over waste tracking	Yuktāhār's management introduced item-level waste recording	Staff first read it as surveillance (”they are catching us”). Managers made it blame-free, discussed it daily and paired it with cross-checking ”not to find fault”, which settled the conflict by December
Operator autonomy vs. centralised prediction	Yuktāhār keeps prediction on paper and in its own meeting, and dropped a commercial ERP because paying lakhs of rupees for prediction made no sense with the data already in its books for a mess of 300 to 350 diners, and its staff are not digitally inclined (single-sourced)	An institution-designed forecasting tool would take that judgement out of the operator's hands
Academic schedule vs. meal schedule	Academic administration owns class timing and has no stake in mess outcomes	Students bear the cost of the 8:30 AM overlap with breakfast, and operators absorb it as the closing surge

Findings

Thirty-two candidate stakeholders were narrowed to twenty-four on direct evidence. Three lenses that might plausibly have produced a stakeholder (student health, senior-to-junior norms, a parental financial relationship) produced none.

The Mess Office is distinct from the Mess Committee, separating who decides policy from who executes it. Every earlier account, including this team's first drafts, had collapsed the two. The Office owns the four-day registration rule, passes registration counts to operators, runs the platform and issued the one confirmed policy change on

record, which was motivated by workload (candidate). Revised: it does not place food orders. Operators buy their own stock on their own cadence, and the four-day count sets only how much cooked food they prepare.

The operators are the largest part the first map left out, and each runs a different planning regime. Yuktāhār plans at a twice-daily meeting from the Wastage Book for the matching week (the menu repeats in weeks one and three, and two and four), the weekday register, the month's pattern, holidays and events, and a run-out rule (”if it runs out at 1:30 we re-cook; if at 2:20 we don't”). The books are confirmed; the rule is single-sourced. During service it samples the first half hour to project the rest. Kadamba cooks about 70% of registrations first against a gram standard for every dish, and its supervisor calls top-ups from a raw reserve. Its manager says there is no forecasting method, and the gram standard is its only standing record. Revised: Bakul was read as a fixed 70% raised to 80%, with top-ups inside 30 minutes. Its manager cooks 70 to 80% by item, adjusted weekly from attendance history, keeps about 70% even on low weekends because there should be no shortage even if food is wasted, and tops up by phone on an unstated lead time (single-sourced). Yuktāhār's matching-week learning against Kadamba's fixed ratio is the cleanest comparison in the map, and Bakul's weekly judgement with a floor sits between them (candidate). Every recorded planning figure sits well above actual turnout: 37.1% at Kadamba in April and about 28% at Yuktāhār in September (confirmed, records), against Yuktāhār's belief of at most about 50% and Bakul's manager's estimate of at most about 60%. His first batch and weekend floor both exceed even that, and if Bakul resembles the recorded halls the gap is larger and its size unknown (candidate). At the two recorded halls, then, the operators' conversion factors are miscalibrated upward.

The registration-to-attendance gap is already measured twice and reaches nobody who sets the rules. The CDS team holds a timestamp for every Kadamba breakfast scan (11,941 of 32,162 registrations availed in April, confirmed). Yuktāhār records registered against eaten by weekday and waste by item, in books each checked by someone other than its keeper. Kadamba keeps a gram standard per dish and watches its counters but records nothing of what was eaten. At Bakul the measurement is the manager's weekly review, and no source says whether any of it is written down, so it may live in one head (candidate). None of these measurements is confirmed to reach the owner of registration and billing policy, and they do not reach each other: no source shows CDS sharing scans with operators, or operators' registers reaching CDS or the Mess Committee.

Academic administration holds the lever most likely to affect the core problem, the overlap between breakfast hours and the 8:30 AM class start, and has no relationship of any kind to the three mess-governance actors. It is the clearest sleeping stakeholder in the map: total authority over the one variable in conflict, and zero engagement with the system it conflicts with. The operator evidence extends the gap downward. Exams, hackathons and campus events cut turnout, yet reach a kitchen only if someone raises them in a meeting.

Three feedback channels exist on the student side (an in-app per-meal rating, a public email address and Ping) and none has a confirmed instance of changing a policy. The operator side adds channels the first map missed: complaints from a director's email or the CDS team to the manager and kitchen (at Bakul on to the managing director), the WhatsApp group between the CDS site team and each operator, the facility team's tasting with Prism before service, and complaints made in person at the counter. It also adds the one working internal feedback loop anywhere in the system, Yuktāhār's Wastage Book, run-out times and weekday register feeding the next meeting, which took hold only once measurement was made blame-free (single-sourced). The fortnightly menu rotation that makes that loop possible is a confirmed policy change, and it came through the governance route from CDS to the Student Council to the Student Parliament (single-sourced, CFS Chair), not through any student feedback channel.

Revised: the first version found registered attendance markedly lower, against capacity, at every North Indian mess, read as three independently run messes pointing to cuisine. That no longer stands. Bakul is served by Vijayalakshmi Caterers from Hafizpet (single-sourced) and Palash from the same off-site kitchen (candidate), so the pattern does not come from three independent messes, and an off-site kitchen where food is held hot for hours and softens in transit is a competing explanation (candidate). The Bakul manager's view that North and South Indian eating patterns differ is a hypothesis from experience, not evidence for cuisine. Turnout records show cuisine and item driving attendance inside a single mess too: at Kadamba non-veg breakfast registrations were availed at 48.5% and veg at 32.4%. Cuisine is one factor among several.

The Mess Committee's chair, reported as a faculty member by a secondhand source we could not verify, is a second, subtler candidate sleeping stakeholder if that report holds: a person with cross-institutional standing that no

student channel has and a plausible bridge to Academic administration, with no evidence the bridge has been used. Kadamba's manager describes IIIT faculty inspecting the store, and the operator describes a weekly QC inspection and a facility team that tastes every meal with Prism. These are the only signs of institutional contact with the kitchens, and whether any belongs to the Committee is a candidate only.

The Student Parliament has an elected Mess Secretary and a Mess Deputy Secretary for each mess (Kadamba, Palash, Yuktāhār), known from the Parliament's published records (single-sourced). It is a real, structured channel of student representation, and it sits in the internal ring beside the Committee, Office and Warden.

Surplus leaves the system through people and a bin, not a compost heap, at least at Kadamba. Revised: staff eating leftovers is replaced. Kadamba cooks about 30 extra portions for 30 to 50 outside diners, about half its staff eat from the same food (single-sourced), latecomers are fed through the reopened door and the back door, Yuktāhār turns leftover idli into idli upma or idli poha for lunch and sets surplus milk as curd, and the rest of Kadamba's cooked surplus goes to a dustbin the garbage contractor empties. Kadamba's 5 to 10% waste figure, on an unstated base, sits uneasily with a 70% batch against 37% turnout: either the extra diners, reheating and small top-ups absorb most of the surplus, or the percentage uses another base. The evidence does not say which. The first version's assumption that composting absorbs the physical surplus is revised for Kadamba, whose manager says there is no composting (single-sourced). The CFS Chair earlier said a collector takes waste to an outside compost facility, and the manager may mean only that nothing is composted on site, so the onward route stays open and the garbage contractor is the single point where all of Kadamba's waste leaves.

Revised: the first version named the four-day procurement lead time as a hidden actor capping the system's response to any same-day signal. Kitchens respond within 10 to 30 minutes and buy perishables a day ahead, so that finding no longer holds. Three other hidden actors carry outsized influence without being visible to any one respondent. The Portal and IT owner is used constantly and named by no one. The four-day registration lock is a Mess Office rule that fixes the student's commitment long before they know whether they will eat. The first-batch share is a rule of thumb held by each operator, fixed at Kadamba, a weekly judgement at Bakul that can fall only as far as its floor of about 70% (single-sourced), and it turns the four-day commitment into cooked food that lasts three to four hours.

Several questions remain open after the operator visits. The most consequential is whether operators are paid per registered or per served plate, and what the deductions are, since that decides who gains from no-shows. Bakul's ”served” needs confirming from the contract or CDS, along with whether Kadamba's basis differs. Whether Palash is served by the same operator and kitchen as Bakul needs confirming. At Bakul it is open whether anything behind the weekly adjustment is written down, how long a top-up takes, which menu decisions students control and the manager can override, and why Bakul residents skip breakfast. Who heads CDS is open, as is whether Skip Meal changes the count Kadamba cooks from, which needs a direct answer. At Yuktāhār, whether the mess in-charge is the person the recording calls ”Adit Amma”, and whether the site head is one of the two project managers, are unconfirmed. Also open: who the facility team is, what the outside registration for night security is and who pays for those portions, what base Kadamba's waste figure uses, who decides the menu at Kadamba, whether any operator's item-level waste figures reach the Committee, whether CDS ever shares scans back, the onward route of Kadamba's waste, the identity of faculty quality-check visitors, whether staff meals are an entitlement, and whether any channel could carry the academic and event calendar to the kitchens. The identities between CDS, CFS and the bodies named earlier need a direct answer from CDS leadership, which has not been interviewed.